Name: _____ **Group:** _____ **Date:** _____

4 ESO · SEASONS & CELEBRATIONS · ROUTE PRO

Sample exam

✏️ Paper worksheet: do the same activities as on the computer. Write your answers and circle the letter of the right option. Do it without notes the first time.

1 Before the exam: shadowing for the whole unit

A 6-minute review for listening and speaking: sentences from the unit's recordings. Listen, say them out loud, then do it again with no text. The video waits for you.

2 How the exam works (C2 version)

Same sections and points as your class's exam, with C2 Proficiency-style tasks. **55 minutes, no notes.**

1 Listening: attitude and implication (5) + detail and purpose (5), 2 points each	20
2 Reading: a C2 text (5) + summary accuracy (5), 2 points each	20
3 Vocabulary: multiple-choice cloze (7 × 1) + word formation (4 × 2)	15
4 Grammar: open cloze (7 × 1) + key word transformations (4 × 2)	15
5 Writing: a formal letter (C2 Proficiency, Part 2)	30

Your **first try** is your score. The letter gets feedback and a guide mark from ChatGPT.

⚠️ ChatGPT can make mistakes: its mark is only a guide.

3 Listening: Two New Years

🎧 **Two New Years: Callum and Yuki** · If you cannot listen to it, read transcript 1 at the end of the worksheet (twice, as if you were listening).

1. Callum's comment that Hogmanay is "bigger than Christmas" mainly reveals… [2 points]
   a) that Christmas is not celebrated in Scotland
   b) how central the celebration is to Scottish identity for him **c)** that the street party is very crowded
   d) that he prefers parties to presents
2. How does Callum feel about nobody knowing all the words to "Auld Lang Syne"? [2 points]
   a) embarrassed **b)** critical of the tradition **c)** indifferent **d)** amused and affectionate
3. Callum's grandmother making sure "a friendly neighbour comes first" suggests that she… [2 points]
   a) wants to be the first visitor herself **b)** is afraid of her neighbours
   c) takes the superstition half-seriously but still acts on it **d)** does not believe in the tradition at all
4. The contrast between the two speakers is best described as… [2 points]
   a) religious versus secular **b)** urban versus rural **c)** traditional versus modern
   d) outward celebration versus inward renewal
5. Yuki's tone when she describes New Year as "starting again" is… [2 points]
   a) reflective **b)** excited **c)** nostalgic and sad **d)** ironic

© 2026 Roger Beltran · English Lab · All rights reserved

4 Listening: detail and purpose

🎧 **Two New Years: Callum and Yuki** · If you cannot listen to it, read transcript 1 at the end of the worksheet (twice, as if you were listening).

6. Why does Callum mention the three jumpers? [2 points]

   a) to explain the dress code **b)** to complain about the weather **c)** to show how poor the organisation is **d)** to add a humorous, vivid detail about the cold

7. What is the purpose of the story about the slice of cake? [2 points]

   a) to describe a typical Scottish recipe **b)** to criticise his neighbours' generosity **c)** to explain what food is eaten at Hogmanay **d)** to show the warmth of the first-footing custom from personal experience

8. Which detail shows that Shōgatsu affects the whole of society, not only families? [2 points]

   a) Children get money in envelopes. **b)** Her grandmother cooks for days. **c)** People eat long noodles. **d)** Schools and many offices close for several days.

9. The cards that "all arrive on the same morning" suggest… [2 points]

   a) that only teachers receive cards **b)** a shared, nationwide moment of connection **c)** that cards are no longer popular **d)** that the postal service is slow

10. What links the cleaning on 31 December and leaving problems behind? [2 points]

    a) Both are done only by children. **b)** Both are done to please the family. **c)** Both are recent customs. **d)** Both express the idea of a fresh start.

5 Reading: The calendar inside the calendar

The calendar inside the calendar

Children in Catalonia spend the first weeks of December feeding a log. They cover it with a blanket, give it scraps of bread and orange peel, and on Christmas Eve, armed with sticks and a song whose lyrics would not survive translation into polite company, they beat it until it "produces" sweets. Children in Britain, meanwhile, open one cardboard door a day until the twenty-fourth. Put side by side, the two customs look like opposites: one riotous and faintly absurd, the other orderly to the point of bureaucracy.

Yet they are doing the same job. Both stretch a single day into a season, and both give children something adults often forget they once needed: a way of making waiting bearable. The log must be fed; the door must not be opened early. In each case, anticipation is turned into a ritual with rules, and the rules, rather than the reward, are what children remember.

It would be easy to read the commercial Advent calendar, now available in versions containing cheese, beauty products and craft beer, as proof that the ritual has been hollowed out. The Caga Tió has its own market too: miniature logs with painted smiles are sold in airport shops to tourists who have no intention of feeding them. But the market follows the ritual rather than replacing it. Families still argue about the right day to bring out the Tió, and children still police the calendar with a seriousness out of all proportion to the chocolate behind each door.

11. In the first paragraph, the writer presents the two customs as… [2 points]

    a) both religious **b)** apparently opposite in character **c)** equally old **d)** both commercial

12. What is the "same job" both customs do, according to the writer? [2 points]

    a) They turn waiting into a structured experience. **b)** They replace religious practices. **c)** They teach children to share. **d)** They keep children busy during the holidays.

© 2026 Roger Beltran · English Lab · All rights reserved

13. The phrase “the rules, rather than the reward, are what children remember” suggests that… [2 points]

a) the process matters more than the prize **b)** parents should give fewer presents

c) children are disappointed by the sweets **d)** the customs are too strict

14. What is the writer’s view of the commercial versions of the customs? [2 points]

a) They have emptied the customs of meaning.

b) They exist because of the ritual and have not destroyed it. **c)** They are a recent improvement.

d) They are mainly bought by children.

15. The phrase “a seriousness out of all proportion” is used to… [2 points]

a) criticise children for being greedy **b)** suggest the chocolate is expensive

c) show that adults take the custom too seriously

d) affectionately highlight how much the ritual matters to children

6 Summary accuracy

Use the text in the Reading section.

16. Which is the most accurate one-sentence summary of the text? [2 points]

a) Catalan and British children celebrate Christmas in the same way.

b) The Caga Tió is older and more meaningful than the Advent calendar.

c) Two very different customs both turn the wait for Christmas into a ritual that has survived commercialisation.

d) Commercial Advent calendars have destroyed a children’s tradition.

17. Which paraphrase of “making waiting bearable” is accurate? [2 points]

a) rewarding children for patience **b)** stopping children from waiting **c)** making children wait longer

d) helping children cope with anticipation

18. Which note best captures paragraph 3? [2 points]

a) tourists feed the Tió **b)** calendars now contain beer **c)** ritual has been hollowed out

d) commercial versions exist · but ritual still drives them

19. Which of these is NOT a point the writer makes? [2 points]

a) The Tió is sold to tourists. **b)** Children take the calendar rules seriously.

c) Parents prefer the Advent calendar because it is tidier. **d)** Both customs stretch one day into a season.

20. Which word best describes the writer’s tone overall? [2 points]

a) sentimental **b)** wry **c)** indignant **d)** neutral and technical

7 Vocabulary: multiple-choice cloze and word formation

21. The village festival is ___ in tradition. [1 point]

a) drowned **b)** steeped **c)** soaked **d)** filled

22. Halloween is ___ in the Celtic festival of Samhain. [1 point]

a) grown **b)** based **c)** planted **d)** rooted

23. Organising the fair was no mean ___. [1 point]

a) act **b)** deed **c)** task **d)** feat

24. The plan quickly ___ momentum. [1 point]

a) collected **b)** gathered **c)** built **d)** raised

© 2026 Roger Beltran · English Lab · All rights reserved

25. We need to ___ a balance between tradition and change. [1 point]
a) make **b)** strike **c)** reach **d)** hit

26. The custom ___ into disuse after the war. [1 point]
a) fell **b)** dropped **c)** came **d)** went

27. At the ___ of repeating myself: label the food. [1 point]
a) chance **b)** risk **c)** threat **d)** danger

28. Word formation: Critics complain about the _____ (COMMERCIAL) of the festival. [2 points]

29. Word formation: The festival gives people a sense of _____ (BELONG). [2 points]

30. Word formation: The custom is _____ (SURPRISE) recent. [2 points]

31. Word formation: The candles are lit with _____ (REVERE). [2 points]

8 Grammar: open cloze and key word transformations

32. Open cloze (one word): No sooner had the bells rung _____ the fireworks began. [2 points]

33. Open cloze: _____ it rain, the parade will be postponed. [2 points]

34. Open cloze: It is not the presents _____ that matter. [2 points]

35. Open cloze: Little _____ they know what was coming. [2 points]

36. Open cloze: The custom is said to _____ originated in Ireland. [2 points]

37. Open cloze: _____ more we prepare, the less we worry. [2 points]

38. Open cloze: The answer lies _____ lowering our expectations. [2 points]

39. KWT: I have never seen such a crowd. NEVER → _____ such a crowd. [2 points]

40. KWT: People believe the festival began in Ireland. THOUGHT → The festival _____ in Ireland. [2 points]

41. KWT: If you have any questions, please contact us. SHOULD → _____ any questions, please contact us. [2 points]

42. KWT: Thanksgiving did not become official until 1863. ONLY → It was _____ Thanksgiving became official. [2 points]

9 43. Writing: a formal letter (C2)

Write without notes, as in the exam.

Your task [30 points]
The community centre in your town is preparing an International New Year evening for families on Friday 8 January. Write a formal **letter** (240–280 words) to Mr Jordi Serra, the director, proposing an activity about a New Year tradition from another country. Explain what the activity would involve and why it would appeal to families of all backgrounds, anticipate one practical concern, and request what you need.

The community centre in the student's town is preparing an International New Year evening for families on Friday 8 January. The class wants to run an activity about a New Year tradition from another country. The email is to Mr Jordi Serra, the director of the community centre.

© 2026 Roger Beltran · English Lab · All rights reserved

© 2026 Roger Beltran · English Lab · All rights reserved

Transcripts (only if you cannot listen)

Transcript 1 · Two New Years: Callum and Yuki

Callum: [cheerful] Hi, I’m Callum, from Edinburgh in Scotland. In Scotland, New Year’s Eve is called Hogmanay, and for us it’s bigger than Christmas! There’s a huge street party in the city centre, with concerts and fireworks over the castle at midnight. It’s usually freezing, so you wear about three jumpers. [laughs]

Callum: Then everyone holds hands and sings an old song, “Auld Lang Syne”. [laughs] Nobody knows all the words! It’s a song about old friends and remembering the good times. After midnight, we go “first-footing”: you visit your neighbours and you’re the first person to walk into their house in the new year.

Callum: You bring a small present, like shortbread or a piece of coal for the fire. My gran says the first visitor brings luck for the whole year, so she always makes sure a friendly neighbour comes first. Last year I was our neighbours’ first visitor, and they gave me a huge slice of cake. What I love is that the whole street feels like one big family.

Yuki: [calm] Hello, I’m Yuki, and I’m from Osaka in Japan. New Year, or Shōgatsu, is the most important holiday of the year for my family. Schools and many offices close for several days, and lots of people travel home to their parents’ houses. [thoughtful] It’s quite quiet, not like a party.

Yuki: On the thirty-first of December, we clean the whole house, so we can start the year fresh. In the evening we eat long noodles, because they mean a long life. At midnight, temple bells ring one hundred and eight times. On the first of January, we eat special food that my mother and grandmother cook for days, and we visit a shrine to pray for a good year. Children get money in small envelopes.

Yuki: We also send New Year cards to our friends and teachers, and they all arrive on the same morning. [softly] For me, New Year is about starting again. You leave the problems of the old year behind, and you thank your family for everything.

© 2026 Roger Beltran · English Lab · All rights reserved